

Course Feedback and Responses

14.33 Research and Communication in Economics

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Common themes

- Example papers
- Course structure
- Policies and logistics

Can we see past projects?

- **Verdict:** No
- **Why:** respect student privacy and avoid limiting creativity
- **Similar format:** American Economic Review: Insights, Journal of Public Economics (Short Papers), Review of Economics and Statistics (Short Papers), and Journal of Urban Economics: Insights

Can we read more economics papers?

- **Verdict:** Yes, in service of your project
- **Why:** build skill of efficient skimming and situate project in literature
- **Plan:** short reading guidance memo and an in-class exercise

Can we have more lectures?

- **Verdict:** Keep the planned structure
- **Why:** more lectures come at the expense of fewer (universally liked!) 1-on-1 meetings or communication practice

Can the final exam count less or happen earlier?

- **Verdict:** No
- **Why:** exam disincentivizes cognitive offloading and pre-exam week timing crowds out meetings
- **Expectation:** nothing to study for if you have ownership over the project you submit

Can we collaborate more with peers?

- **Verdict:** Individual-meeting class sessions heavily involve group exercises and peer feedback
- **Boundary:** submitted assignments remain individual work

Will final drafts use a scripted language?

- **Verdict:** Yes. Quarto rather than LaTeX
- **Why:** one-click reproducibility and publication-ready output
- **Sequence:** manual prose drafting first, migration at the end

Will we cover research proposals?

- **Verdict:** Not as core course content
- **Why:** the format depends on the proposal's purpose
- **Support:** bring a specific proposal type to office hours

Can the absence policy be more flexible?

- **Verdict:** The policy remains
- **Why:** absences reduce your learning and your classmates' feedback

Can assignments be posted on Canvas?

- **Verdict:** Yes. Done